New England CRE *Weekly*.

April 14 — 21, 2026

Eight days of deals, approvals, and policy shifts across Greater Boston and New England — and what they mean for the rest of the year.

— THE BRIEF

Boston's planning machinery came back on this week. The Planning Department cleared 1.7 million square feet in one Thursday meeting, Samuels closed a $360M CMBS refi on Lyrik Back Bay, and JLL showed Q1 industrial demand up 83% year-over-year. Suburbs and Route 495 did the leasing. Somerville and Lexington are suddenly competing for the density story.

Underneath the deal flow, the real conversation has shifted. Rates are no longer the variable every sponsor is underwriting against. Parking minimums, a statewide rent-control ballot in November, and municipal soft costs are. Capital is already moving because of it.

— THE WEEK IN NUMBERS

Four figures define the week. None of them are small — and all four point in the same direction.

$360M

CAPITAL MARKETS

Samuels' CMBS refi of Lyrik Back Bay — largest Boston office refi since 2022.

1.7M SF

DEVELOPMENT

Cleared by the BPD in one Thursday: Longwood, Charlestown, Harvard ERC.

+83%

INDUSTRIAL DEMAND

Greater Boston Q1 year-over-year jump, per JLL — six deals over 100K SF.

600

MULTIFAMILY UNITS

High end of two competing bids for a single 4-acre Somerville parcel.

— THIS WEEK'S TAKE

Three *patterns* under the headlines.

I. **The thaw is real — and bifurcating.** Capital is returning, but only to trophy assets, and only in the asset classes the market has already re-priced. Class B in secondary locations still can't finance at meaningful scale.

II. **Entitlement velocity is quietly back.** One BPD meeting cleared more square footage this week than some months of 2025. The multi-year planning backlog is starting to move.

III. **Policy is now the dominant underwriting variable.** Parking minimums, the November rent-control ballot, and municipal soft costs are driving more capital-allocation decisions than interest rates are.

— CAPITAL MARKETS · OFFICE

Samuels lands a $360M refi — and CMBS reopens for trophy office.

Samuels & Associates and JV partner Jiaming Investment America closed a $360 million CMBS loan on the Lyrik office tower in Back Bay. Proceeds refinance roughly $323M of construction debt and return $17M of equity to the sponsors.

> *Largest Boston office refi since 2022. 93.4% leased, anchored by CarGurus and Lego.*

WHY IT MATTERS

A clean comp for every downtown sponsor sitting on maturing construction debt. It also sharpens the bifurcation: trophy office finances and trades. Commodity Class B still doesn't.

SOURCE Bisnow Boston — April 16, 2026

— DEVELOPMENT · APPROVALS

Boston cleared 1.7M SF in a single Thursday meeting.

The Planning Department approved four projects at its April 17 hearing: Skanska and Simmons' Longwood Place (227 units); New England Development's 240-unit Charlestown building; Harvard's ERC District plan in Allston; plus West Roxbury and South Boston infill.

> *More pipeline cleared in one night than the city moved through in most months of 2025.*

WHY IT MATTERS

Entitlement velocity has been the missing link in Boston's housing math for three years. If April's pace holds into summer, downtown zoning reforms and the MBTA Communities Act finally start showing up as real supply.

SOURCE Bisnow Boston Deal Sheet — April 20, 2026

— INDUSTRIAL · MARKET DATA

Q1 industrial demand jumped 83%. The big tenants are back.

Per JLL, Q1 leasing volume rose 73% and total demand rose 83% against Q1 2025, driven by six deals over 100,000 SF. SupplyOne signed 210,000 SF at 586 Manley St. in West Bridgewater. Pandemic-era spec supply is finally being absorbed.

> *SupplyOne took 210,000 SF. VMD added 180,000 SF of build-to-suits in Middleborough. It's back.*

WHY IT MATTERS

If it holds, Greater Boston industrial vacancy peaked in late 2025. Owners of recently delivered spec product on Routes 495 and 146 get paid first. South Shore build-to-suit demand shows where the next wave actually lands.

SOURCE JLL via Bisnow Boston — April 19, 2026

— MULTIFAMILY · SUBURBAN

The *suburbs* are finally saying yes.

LEXINGTON · APRIL 17

Pulte wins approval for 150 units at the former tennis club.

Atlanta-based Pulte cleared Lexington Planning Board for Fieldside — 150 apartments replacing the Lexington Tennis Club at 475 Bedford St.

SOMERVILLE · APRIL 21

Two developers, one site, a 260-unit spread.

On a 4-acre parcel at 90 Washington St., North River Leerink pitched up to 600 apartments; Wood Partners countered with ~340.

WHY IT MATTERS

Route 128 suburbs and GLX corridors are producing real, national-merchant-builder pipeline for the first time since the MBTA Communities Act took effect. The Somerville bid spread is the live test of how far density will be pushed.

SOURCE Boston Business Journal, Banker & Tradesman — April 17 & 21

— POLICY WATCH

Two live votes will reshape every Boston *pro forma*.

CITY · APRIL 15

Councilors push to eliminate parking minimums.

Citing collapsing housing starts and a budget crunch, two councilors want to drop residential parking requirements citywide.

STATE · NOVEMBER

Statewide rent-control ballot looms.

The November 2026 question is already shifting MA multifamily acquisition strategy — pulling capital toward New Hampshire.

WHY IT MATTERS

Parking minimums are among the most binding cost inputs in Boston multifamily underwriting. Rent control is the single biggest rate-of-return variable. Both decisions move inside the same 90-day window.

SOURCE Bisnow Boston, Banker & Tradesman — April 15 & 19

— CAPITAL STRATEGY

MA sponsors are quietly shopping across the *NH* line.

Per reporting in Banker & Tradesman, Arrowpoint Properties CEO David Lamattina said the firm is looking toward Southern New Hampshire for multifamily acquisitions — citing the November rent-control ballot as a defining Massachusetts underwriting risk. The publication reported Lowell value-add sales and recent NH buys.

> *They are not the only ones. Several MA-focused sponsors have widened into NH, RI, and southern Maine.*

WHY IT MATTERS

If the ballot polls competitively this summer, expect more sponsors to move. MA cap rates on value-add product widen further before the vote — not after.

SOURCE Banker & Tradesman — April 19, 2026

— ALSO THIS WEEK

07 OFFICE LEASING · FINANCIAL DISTRICT

AI firm Lovable takes 6,000 SF at One Lincoln.

Small footprint, but another AI-adjacent name joining HarbourVest, Sherin & Lodgen, and WeWork. Downtown's recovery keeps being written by small and mid-sized tech.

08 INDUSTRIAL · MIDDLEBOROUGH

VMD Cos. signs 180K SF of build-to-suits at Canopy Drive.

Rexa takes 110K SF manufacturing; Indus takes 70K SF paving. The South Shore and Route 44 corridor is where the next wave of demand is landing.

09 INVESTMENT SALES · STOUGHTON

Reclamation Partners buys 33,619 SF of net-leased industrial.

Clean, single-tenant, credit-tenant industrial at 1023 Turnpike St. — exactly the kind of deal that had stalled in 2024. Private capital continues to lead Boston volume.

10 HIGHER ED · STUDENT HOUSING

Hampshire's closure has Boston schools rethinking real-estate costs.

Smaller private colleges are consolidating footprints and sharing dorms, while BPD keeps approving new purpose-built housing for the well-capitalized research universities.

— LOOKING AHEAD

Four *signals* worth tracking.

01 **Rent-control polling and coalition activity around the Massachusetts ballot.**
Where sentiment lands in May dictates Q3 acquisition behavior.

02 **Follow-on CMBS pricing on other Boston trophy refis.**
Samuels set the comp. Does anyone else clear it?

03 **Q1 life-science vacancy prints from Colliers, JLL, and CBRE.**
The one sector that hasn't meaningfully turned.

04 **More GLX suburb RFP responses after the Somerville spread.**
Density expectations for transit-oriented sites are being reset in real time.

That's the *week*.

Eleven items. Eleven primary sources.
One read on what it all means.

→ NEW BRIEFINGS EVERY WEEK